

PATTERN RETAIL

Brand Style Guide

Visual identity, voice and interface standards — built on the Support Portal design system.

VERSION	ISSUED	OWNER	APPLIES TO
2.0	June 2026	Pattern Retail Ops	Portal, dashboards, client reports & documents

The Pattern Retail brand at a glance

Pattern Retail builds stock allocation and business intelligence software for retailers. Our brand reads the way our products work: clear, structured, signal-led — never decorative. The Support Portal sets the standard. Every artefact, from the portal itself to a one-page client email, follows the same small set of rules so that anything from Pattern looks unmistakably from Pattern.

Five principles

- **Clarity over completeness** — every screen and artefact answers one question.
- **Forward visibility** — surface what needs action now: SLA risk, breaches, the next move.
- **Signal, not decoration** — no drop shadows, gradients, or full-width colour bars.
- **Amber is a cue, not a fill** — a thin accent on the lead card, never a background.
- **Tables over paragraphs** — show the data, then write one line that explains it.

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Brand cue and accent system

Pattern Retail does not rely on a heavy logo lockup. The brand reads through two consistent cues: the **warm dark surface** the whole product sits on, and a single **amber left-accent border** on the lead card of any view. That is the whole system.

Where the amber accent is allowed

- Left edge of the lead summary / KPI card.
- Left edge of a callout or rule strip in long-form documents.
- Focus ring on inputs and the active filter control.
- Short underline beneath a section title (this guide).

Where it is never used

- As a background fill, gradient, or full-width banner.
- On more than one card in a single card row.
- As body or heading text colour.
- Inside data marks — the semantic palette does that work.

ACCENT CUE — LEAD SUMMARY CARD

TOTAL OPEN TICKETS

42

across all business units

RESOLVED

128

last 30 days

ACCENT CUE — CALLOUT STRIP

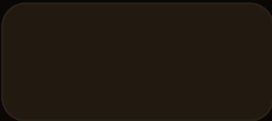
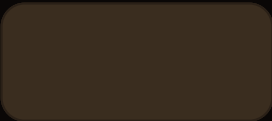
RULE

One amber accent per view. It marks the single thing the reader should look at first — never a decorative repeat.

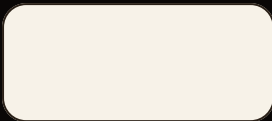
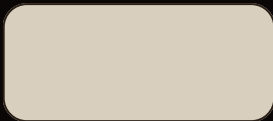
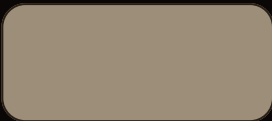
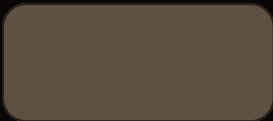
Colour — surfaces and text

The portal sits on a warm near-black base with three darker-to-lighter surface steps and a four-stop text ramp. Amber is the one accent. Holding to this palette is the single biggest thing you can do to keep an artefact on-brand.

SURFACES — WARM DARK

					
Base #0A0706 App background	Surface #1B140D Cards, table body	Surface 2 #221A11 Table header, hover	Border #2A2017 Hairline dividers	Border 2 #3A2D1F Control borders	Amber #E8923E Brand accent

TEXT RAMP — CREAM TO FAINT

			
Cream #F7F2E8 Headings, values	Body #D9CFBE Body text	Muted #9C8E78 Labels, eyebrows, sub-text	Faint #5C5142 Placeholders, disabled

RULE

Surfaces and text carry 95% of every Pattern artefact. Amber is the 5% — one accent per view, never a fill. Semantic colours (Section 04) are reserved for the data layer: badges, SLA states and status dots, not the page chrome.

Colour — semantic and status

Four semantic colours, tuned to read on the warm dark surface. Each is used as a triplet: a 16% fill, a ~32% border ring, and the saturated hue for text and dots. Roles are fixed — danger = breached, warn = at risk, success = healthy, info = in progress.

SEMANTIC PALETTE — FILL · RING · TEXT



Info
#6FA6E0
In progress, on track

Warn
#F0B854
At risk SLA

Danger
#E26A60
Breached SLA, P1



Success
#6CC08A
Resolved, met

BADGES IN USE



STATUS DOTS — TICKET STAGES

New	#5C5142
Acknowledged	#6FA6E0
In Progress	#F5A14B
On Hold	#F0B854
Business Review	#C77A28
Resolved	#6CC08A
Reopened	#E26A60

DATA-COLOUR RULE

Badge text and dots use the saturated hue; the surface fill stays at 16% with a ring at ~32%. Never set semantic colour on body copy, and never mix two semantic fills in one cell.

Typography

Pattern Retail uses Inter across the product and every artefact. One typeface, four weights, one scale. Numbers use tabular figures so values align in tables and cards. Ticket references use a monospace face.

TYPEFACE

Inter

Regular 400 · Medium 500 · SemiBold 600 · Bold 700

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789

Mono – ticket refs: PEP-1042 · TT-0931

TYPE SCALE

Role	Style	Where
Cover title	Bold 74px	Cover only
Page / view title	Bold 24–30px	Dashboard h1, section titles
KPI value	SemiBold 30px	Summary cards
Heading	SemiBold 14px	Block headings in body copy
Body	Regular 13–14px	Paragraph copy, table cells
Label / eyebrow	Medium 9.5–12px	Uppercase labels, card labels
Footer / meta	Regular 8–10px	Footers, ticket refs, hints

TYPE RULES

Body copy is regular weight; SemiBold is reserved for titles, KPI values and table headers. Headings sit tight (letter-spacing –0.02em). ALL CAPS is for labels, eyebrows and column headers at ≤ 12px only — never body or titles. Don't underline; use a hairline or the amber accent instead. Aim for one idea per line on cards and 70–90 characters in paragraphs.

Tone of voice and writing style

Pattern Retail writes the way our product works. Direct, structured, signal-led. Readers should be able to skim a screen or page and pick up the call without reading every word.

VOICE — ATTRIBUTES

- Plain. Short sentences. Active verbs. No corporate verbiage.
- Confident, not promotional. Describe what is, not what we hope.
- Specific. Use names, dates, numbers. 'Breached 19 May' beats 'overdue'.
- Calm. Even when a ticket is red, the tone is steady. The data does the alarm.
- British English (analyse, organisation, behaviour). Match the client where needed.

DO — WRITE LIKE THIS

- Lead with the call. 'P1 breached; fix deployed, monitoring.'
- Expand acronyms on first use. 'Service Level Agreement (SLA)'.
- Use explicit dates, not 'soon'. '12 May, 14:00 SAST'.
- One idea per line. One status per badge.
- Use 'Business Unit', not 'client team'. Use 'Customer' on portfolio views.

DON'T — AVOID THIS

- Don't hedge. 'Could potentially be considered' = delete.
- Don't write status narrations. The table is the status.
- Don't use exclamation marks. Ever.
- Don't use 'TBC' on a date. Use '—' and surface it as at-risk.
- Don't use marketing words: 'leverage', 'best-in-class', 'robust'.

Components — cards and badges

Cards and badges are the portal's building blocks. Cards are rounded, bordered surfaces; badges are pill states. Both are flat — no shadows, no gradients.

SUMMARY CARDS — LEAD CARD CARRIES THE AMBER ACCENT



Card rules

- Corner radius 16px (rounded-2xl). 1px border in **Border #2A2017**.
- Surface fill #1B140D. Internal padding 16–20px.
- Value in SemiBold 30px, tabular figures; label in muted uppercase above.
- Value colour carries meaning: cream for counts, semantic hue for state.
- Only the lead card gets the 2px amber left border.
- No drop shadow on any card. Ever.

Badge rules

- Pill shape (fully rounded), 11px Medium, 2×9px padding.
- Fill at 16% of the hue; 1px ring at ~32%; text in the saturated hue.
- One badge = one state. Pair with a hint line for due times if needed.
- Neutral badge (P3, N/A) uses white 5% fill and the muted text colour.



Components — tables

Tables are Pattern's primary deliverable — designed shapes, not styled spreadsheets. Header treatment, hairline dividers, pill badges and status dots are the things that stay consistent across every table we ship.

TICKET	PRIORITY	STATUS	BUSINESS UNIT	CREATED	RESOLUTION SLA
PEP-1042 Allocation export times out	P1	● In Progress	Tekkie Town	12 May 2026, 09:14	Breached
DUN-0517 Size curve not refreshing	P2	● Acknowledged	DUNNS	13 May 2026, 11:02	At Risk
COD-0288 New user access request	P3	● Resolved	CODE	10 May 2026, 15:47	Met

- Container is rounded-2xl, 1px **Border**, surface fill — no outer shadow.
 - Header row uses **Surface 2** #221A11; labels are muted, uppercase, 9.5px SemiBold, tracking-wide.
 - Row dividers are hairline #2A2017. No alternating row shading.
- Ticket number in mono/muted; title in cream Medium beneath it.
 - Status uses a coloured dot + label; SLA and Priority use pill badges.
 - Dates as DD Mon YYYY, HH:MM (SAST). Missing date → '—', surfaced as at-risk.
 - Hover row shifts to **Surface 2**; rows are clickable to the detail view.

Layout — dashboard and documents

The portal follows the same skeleton every view: a centred max-width column, a title block, a row of summary cards, filters, then the table. Long-form documents mirror it — eyebrow, title, hairline, body, amber accent on callouts only.

ANATOMY OF THE DASHBOARD



LAYOUT RULES

- Content sits in a centred column, max-width ~1280px, 24px side padding, generous top padding.
- Title block: muted eyebrow/sub line, cream title, then the card row.
- One question per view. If it answers two, split it.
- No dividers, side ribbons, or full-width colour bars.
- No drop shadows on any surface — cards, badges, table, controls.
- Amber accent appears once: the lead card or a single callout.
- Long-form documents mirror the skeleton: eyebrow, title, hairline, body.

Quick reference

COLOUR	
Accent	#E8923E
Base	#0A0706
Surface	#1B140D
Surface 2	#221A11
Border	#2A2017
Cream	#F7F2E8
Body	#D9CFBE
Muted	#9C8E78

TYPE	
Typeface	Inter (400/500/600/700)
Title	Bold 24–30px
KPI value	SemiBold 30px
Body	Regular 13–14px
Label	Medium 9.5–12px caps
Mono	Ticket refs only
SEMANTIC	
Info Warn Danger Success	

CONVENTIONS	
Cards	rounded-2xl · 1px border · flat
Accent	2px amber left border, lead card only
Badges	pill · 16% fill · 32% ring
Tables	Surface 2 header · hairline rows
Dates	DD Mon YYYY, HH:MM (SAST)
Shadows	never
Tone	Specific. Calm. No exclamation marks.

OWNERSHIP

Pattern Retail Operations owns this guide. The Support Portal design system is the source of truth; send corrections or proposed additions to the Ops lead. Reviewed quarterly.